

Rewriting the Script

40–45 min · December Week 2

OBJECTIVE	Students examine the scripts they have inherited about their worth, capacity, and belonging — and practice the Compassionate Witness as a tool for rewriting scripts that are not serving them.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: examining inherited self-narratives · Self-Management: building the Compassionate Witness as a sustained practice
SCENARIO CARDS	None — all work is private and worksheet-guided
QUICK REVIEW	Skip Quick Review. Begin with the OPENING RITUAL — 2 full minutes of grounding before any content.

★★ MANDATORY PRE-LESSON REQUIREMENTS

All must be met before class begins. ☐ School counselor is physically present in the room for the full lesson — NOT on-call, NOT in the hallway ☐ Crisis resources posted VISIBLY: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Crisis Text Line: text HOME to 741741 ☐ Lesson NOT scheduled before a holiday, weekend, break, or fire-drill day ☐ No substitute teacher present — only the delivering teacher ☐ You have briefed the counselor on students who showed concerning patterns in L1–L5 ☐ You have taken 60 seconds to settle yourself before students arrive — your regulated presence is the room's most important safety tool

COUNSELOR CO-FACILITATION ROLE

Sit in a position where you can observe all students without being the centre of attention. Primary job: notice — students who stop writing, leave the room, or show visible distress. **If a student leaves the room: COUNSELOR FOLLOWS. Teacher stays with the class.** After class: mandatory same-day debrief with the teacher — regardless of whether a disclosure occurred.

OPENING · OPENING RITUAL · 4–5 MINUTES · DO NOT SHORTEN

"We all carry scripts — inherited ideas about our worth, our capacity, and whether we belong. Some of these scripts were written by people who loved us. Some were written by people who hurt us. Most were written before we were old enough to question them. Today we look at the scripts — and ask which ones we want to keep."

Pause after this opening. Allow 30 seconds of silence. The counselor holds the room with you.